

NEW BAMBOO ORCHIDS TERMINAL AT GUWAHATI AIRPORT AIMS TO TRANSFORM AIR TRAVEL IN N-E, ENABLE RAPID ECONOMIC GROWTH

The innovative design integrates sustainable architecture with cultural elements creating ample open spaces that are eco-friendly and deeply rooted in local identity

The North-East (N-E) region of India holds tremendous significance for the country's tourism and trade sectors. Known for its breathtaking landscapes, diverse cultures and rich heritage, the region attracts tourists seeking unique immersive experiences. The N-E's verdant hills, pristine rivers and vibrant festivals offer a one-of-a-kind journey through these lesser-explored parts of India. The region, which shares borders with several countries including Bhutan, Bangladesh, Myanmar and China, presents vast strategic opportunities for cross-border trade and commerce amid the government's emphasis on the 'Act East Policy'. The policy aims to create India's deep engagement with the 10 countries in the Association of Southeast Nations (ASEAN) bloc. Enhanced air connectivity through advanced infrastructure projects such as the under-construction Terminal 2 at Lokpriya Gopinath Bordoloi International (LGBI) Airport, managed by Guwahati International Airport Limited (GIAL), is set to unlock the region's immense potential, enabling smoother movement of goods and promoting bilateral trade relations. As the gateway to unexplored natural beauty and rich traditions, the N-E is fast integrating with India's booming economy owing to improved air connectivity.

Design & Inspiration

NUDES, the Mumbai-based principal architect,



developed the unique design concept of the terminal, which draws inspiration from Assam's lush landscapes, cultural heritage and the biodiversity that thrives in the Brahmaputra valley. The project, which is expected to be completed by the end of this year, not only embeds the essence of Assam but also acts as a 'Gateway to the North-East' that reflects the region's identity, a tapestry of its rich natural heritage, cultural vibrancy and ecological sensitivity.

NUDES has drawn profound inspiration from the natural beauty, vibrant flora and cultural

symbols intrinsic to Assam and the wider region. Orchids and bamboo are emblematic of Assam's lush environment. Assam is home to over 600 orchid species, making it a significant part of the state's biodiversity and cultural identity. 'Bamboo Orchids' serve as the primary design motif as bamboo, a diverse group of mostly evergreen perennial flowering plants, is intertwined with the daily life of the N-E, symbolising strength, sustainability and resilience. The design combines these natural elements to create an architectural language that is both organic and sustainable.

